UNSC

Oakridge JMUN 2026

United Nations Security Council

Agenda: Maintenance of International Peace and Security: Assessing the Effectiveness, Enforcement and Exit of Sanctions Regimes

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CONTENTS

1. Letter from the Executive Board 4

2. UNA-USA Rules of Procedure (RoP) 6

- 2.1 Agenda 6
- 2.2 Conduct of Business 7
- 2.3 Points 8
- 2.4 Motions 9
- 2.5 Voting 10

3. Introduction to the United Nations Security Council 12

- 3.1 What Makes the UNSC Unique? 12

4. Understanding Sanctions 13

- 4.1 The Legal Basis for Sanctions 14
- 4.2 How Do Sanctions Work? 14

5. Types of Sanctions 15

- 5.1 Classification by Pathway 15
- 5.2 Classification by the Entity Being Targeted 15
- 5.3 Classification by Purpose: What Are Sanctions Intended to Achieve? 17

6. Strategic Design of Sanctions 17

- 6.1 Defining Clear Objectives 18
- 6.2 Selecting the Appropriate Targets 18
- 6.3 Proportionality and Humanitarian Safeguards 18
- 6.4 Coordination with Other Measures 19

7. Implementation and Enforcement 19

- 7.1 Key Challenges in Implementation 19

8. The Effectiveness of Sanctions 20

8.1 How Can Effectiveness Be Measured? 20

8.2 What Does the Research Show? 21

9. Works Cited and Recommended Sources 22

10. Questions a Resolution Must Answer (QARMA) 23

1. Letter from the Executive Board

Dear Delegates,

We are pleased to welcome you to the United Nations Security Council, being simulated at OakJMUN. As your Executive Board, we are excited to facilitate a committee that challenges you to think critically, negotiate strategically, and engage with the complexities of international diplomacy.

Our agenda, "Maintenance of International Peace and Security: Assessing the Effectiveness, Enforcement and Exit of Sanctions Regimes," calls for a deeper examination of how sanctions shape international relations and whether they can achieve lasting peace without creating unintended consequences.

Equally important is recognising that sanctions rarely affect all parties equally. While they may place pressure on governments or entities responsible for threatening international peace, they can also create economic and humanitarian consequences for civilian populations. The challenge for the Security Council is therefore to design measures that are proportionate, enforceable, and aligned with clearly defined objectives, while ensuring that their continuation remains justified. We encourage you to examine these competing considerations and explore how the international community can balance accountability with humanitarian responsibility.

As you prepare for committee, look beyond your country's immediate interests and consider the broader implications of the policies you propose. Familiarise yourself with relevant Security Council resolutions, past sanctions regimes, and the positions of key international actors. Most importantly, be prepared to defend your proposals with evidence while remaining willing to collaborate with delegates who may approach the issue from very different perspectives.

We encourage you to approach this agenda with thorough research, a clear understanding of your country's foreign policy, and an openness to perspectives beyond your own. While strong arguments are important, effective diplomacy lies in your ability to negotiate, question assumptions, and develop solutions that are both realistic and sustainable.

We hope this committee offers you an opportunity to grow as delegates and leave with a greater appreciation of the challenges faced by the international community. We look forward to an engaging and productive session.

Akash P. Videsh
Chairperson

Hasini Rao Kasuganti
Vice-Chairperson

2. UNA-USA Rules of Procedure (RoP)

The effective functioning of any Model United Nations committee relies on a clear and consistent procedural framework. The UNA-USA Rules of Procedure (RoP) are designed to maintain order, decorum, and efficiency, providing a structured environment for delegates to express their viewpoints, engage in negotiations, and ultimately make decisions on complex agendas within a constrained timeframe. These rules are typically based on a modified version of Robert's Rules of Order, or parliamentary procedure, ensuring a familiar yet adaptable structure for debate.

2.1 Agenda

1. Agenda: The Secretary-General or their representative is responsible for communicating the agenda to all delegates before the commencement of the conference. This ensures that all participants are aware of the topics to be discussed.

2. Adoption of the Agenda: The very first order of business for the committee is the formal adoption of its agenda. At this stage, the only permissible motion is for a delegate to propose placing a specific topic area first on the agenda, articulated as: *"The nation of [country name] moves that [topic area x] be placed first on the agenda."*

- This motion requires a second from another delegate to be considered and is open for debate.
- A provisional speakers list is established, typically allowing three delegates to speak in favour of the motion and three against it, with each speaker allotted one minute.
- Once this provisional speakers list is exhausted, the committee proceeds to an immediate vote, requiring a simple majority for the motion to pass.
- A motion to proceed to the second topic area on the agenda is only in order after a resolution on the first topic has been either adopted or rejected, or if debate on the first topic has been formally adjourned.
- In the event of a crisis or emergency, the President or Vice-President has the authority to call upon a committee to table debate on its current topic to address the more urgent matter. The committee will return to debate the tabled topic after the crisis resolution has been addressed and voted upon. If a resolution on the crisis topic fails, returning to the tabled topic is at the discretion of the President or Vice-President.

2.2 Conduct of Business

3. Speakers List: The Chair will open a speakers list at the request of a delegate. Any delegate wishing to be added to this list should indicate their desire when prompted by the Chair or by submitting a written request to the dais. The General Speakers List shows the order of speakers for the topic on the agenda and is open for the whole duration of the discussion.

4. Limitation of Speaking Time: The Chair has the authority to limit the time allotted to each speaker. However, delegates may propose a motion to either increase or decrease the speaking time, which will then be put to a vote by the committee or council. Should a delegate exceed their allotted time, the Chair may call the speaker to order without delay. The standard speaking time for the General Speakers List is typically 90 seconds, though this can be modified.

5. Speeches: No delegate may address the body without first obtaining permission from the Chair. The Chair may call a speaker to order if their remarks are not relevant to the subject currently under discussion and is responsible for enforcing the time limits as described in Rule 4.

6. Yielding Time: A delegate who has been recognised by the Chair to address the body on a substantive issue may yield any remaining time after their speech. Yields can be made in three distinct ways:

- **Yield to another delegate:** The delegate's remaining time is transferred to another specified delegate.
- **Yield to questions (Points of Information):** The Chair will select delegates from the floor to ask one question per speech. The Chair reserves the right to call to order any delegate whose question is deemed not designed to elicit information. The number of questions recognised is proportional to the time remaining in the original delegate's speech.
- **Yield to the Chair:** This type of yield should be made if the delegate does not wish their speech to be subject to questions. Upon such a yield, the Chair will then move on to the next speaker.

> **Important**
>
> Once a delegate yields their time, the second delegate (the one who has been yielded to) may not further yield any remaining time.

7. Right of Reply: The Chair may recognise a Right of Reply only in instances involving a grave insult to the sovereignty and dignity of a nation. Requests for a Right of Reply must be submitted in writing to the Chair and can only be granted after the completion of a speech. The Chair is required to inform the Secretary-General of the circumstances surrounding the granting of a Right of Reply. A ruling on this matter by the Chair is not subject to appeal.

2.3 Points

8. Point of Personal Privilege: During the discussion of any matter, a delegate may raise a Point of Personal Privilege, and the Chair is obligated to address the point immediately. This point must pertain to a matter of personal comfort, safety, and/or the well-being of the members of the committee (e.g., asking to use the restroom, requesting the speaker to speak louder, or adjusting room temperature). The Chair may refuse to recognise a Point of Personal Privilege if the delegate has not shown proper restraint and decorum, or if the point is dilatory in nature.

9. Point of Order: During the discussion of any matter, a delegate may raise a Point of Order, and the Chair shall immediately consider the request. A Point of Order must relate specifically to the observance of the rules of the committee or to the manner in which the Chair is exercising their power. A delegate raising a Point of Order is strictly prohibited from speaking on the substance of the matter under discussion. The Chair may refuse to recognise a Point of Order if the delegate has not shown proper restraint and decorum governing the use of such a right, or if the point is dilatory in nature.

10. Point of Information (Question to Other Delegates): After a delegate delivers a speech, and if that delegate yields their time to Points of Information, one Point of Information (a question) can be raised by delegates from the floor. The speaker will be allotted the remainder of their speaking time to address these Points of Information. Points of Information are directed to the speaker and allow other delegations to ask questions directly related to the content of speeches and resolutions.

11. Point of Inquiry: If there is no discussion actively taking place on the floor, a delegate may raise a Point of Inquiry to request clarification regarding the present procedural status of a meeting. A Point of Inquiry may never interrupt a speaker.

2.4 Motions

12. Suspend Debate (Motion to Caucus): Upon the recommendation of the Chair or any delegate, the committee may consider a motion to Suspend Debate for the purpose of holding either a moderated or an unmoderated caucus. This motion requires a simple majority vote to pass.

- **Moderated Caucus:** A delegate proposing a moderated caucus must specify a time limit for individual delegate remarks, a total time limit for the entire caucus, and a sub-topic. For example: *"The nation of ABC moves for a five-minute moderated caucus with a 30-second speaking time on the topic XYZ."* During a moderated caucus, the Chair will recognise delegates for remarks without the use of a speakers list, and yields are out of order. This mode is designed to facilitate and accelerate discussion on specific, essential issues pertinent to the agenda.
- **Unmoderated Caucus:** A delegate proposing an unmoderated caucus is required to specify a time limit for its duration. For example: *"The nation of [country name] moves for a ten-minute unmoderated caucus."* Unmoderated caucuses encourage informal, free-flowing discussion and negotiation among delegates, allowing them to move around the room and collaborate. This informal setting is often where significant progress is made, and draft resolutions are merged.

13. Motion to Table Debate: During the discussion of any matter, the committee may consider a motion to table debate on the item currently under discussion, upon the recommendation of the Chair or any delegate. The motion shall immediately be put to a vote. A simple majority is required for its passage.

If a motion to table debate is passed, the topic is considered tabled, and no further actions or votes will be taken on it. A topic may be reintroduced to the committee for debate to resume through the same process, requiring a simple majority for the motion to resume debate to pass.

14. Closure of Debate: A delegate may at any time move for the closure of debate on the item under discussion. If this motion passes, debate will immediately end, and all draft resolutions and amendments pertaining to that topic will be put to an immediate vote. This motion requires a simple majority decision.

Upon passage of this motion, the Chair shall declare the closure of debate and immediately move into the voting procedure on the substantive proposals

introduced and pending before the committee. The committee shall also automatically close debate and move into voting procedure when the speakers list has been exhausted.

15. Adjournment of the Meeting: During the discussion of any matter, a delegate may move for the adjournment of the meeting. Such a motion shall not be debated but shall be immediately put to a vote. After adjournment, the committee shall reconvene at its next regularly scheduled meeting time; adjournment of the final meeting shall adjourn the session.

16. Order of Procedural Motions: The motions below shall have precedence in the following order over all other proposals or motions before the committee. This means a motion higher on this list will be considered before one lower on the list if both are raised simultaneously:

a. Point of Personal Privilege
b. Point of Order
c. Point of Inquiry
d. Point of Information
e. Introduction of a Draft Resolution
f. Motion to Suspend Debate
g. Motion to Table Debate
h. Motion for Closure of Debate
i. Motion to Adjourn the Meeting

2.5 Voting

17. Methods of Decision: All procedural decisions shall be made by a simple majority of the delegations present. Delegations physically present in the committee may not abstain on procedural motions. Decisions on draft resolutions and amendments shall also require a simple majority in favour.

18. Voting Rights: Each present delegation shall have one vote. Observing nations and non-governmental organisations (NGOs) do not have voting rights on substantive matters. Each vote may be a "Yes," "No," or "Abstain." On procedural motions, members may not abstain.

Members designated as "present and voting" are defined as those casting an affirmative or negative vote (i.e., no abstentions) on all substantive votes.

19. Conduct While in Voting Procedure: After the Chair has announced the beginning of voting, no representative may enter or leave the room, nor shall any representative interrupt the voting process except on a Point of Personal Privilege, Point of Inquiry, or a Point of Order directly connected with the actual conduct of the voting. Communication between delegates is strictly forbidden during voting procedure. A member of the staff shall secure the doors during voting procedure.

20. Method of Voting: Delegations may vote in favour of or against a proposal, or they may abstain from voting when appropriate. The committee shall normally vote by a show of placards, but any delegate may request a roll-call vote on substantive matters.

The roll-call vote shall be taken in alphabetical order of the English names of the countries present. During a roll-call vote, delegations may answer with an affirmative vote, a negative vote, or an abstention when appropriate.

21. Order of Draft Resolutions: If two or more draft resolutions relate to the same question, the committee shall vote on the resolutions in the order in which they have been submitted and ratified by the Executive Board.

22. Voting on Unfriendly Amendments: During the voting procedure on a substantive proposal, unfriendly amendments to a resolution shall be voted on first.

When two or more amendments are proposed to a resolution concurrently, the committee shall first vote on the amendment that creates the greatest change to the draft resolution, as deemed by the Chair, and then the amendment that creates the second greatest change to the resolution. This process continues until all amendments are voted upon.

Where, however, the adoption of one amendment necessarily implies the rejection of another amendment, as decided by the Chair, the latter amendment shall not be put to a vote.

If one or more amendments are adopted, the amended proposal shall then be voted upon. Amendment voting is a substantive procedure, and adoption requires the simple majority consent of the delegations present.

23. Passage of Resolutions: If a vote does not result in a simple majority in favour, the resolution shall be regarded as rejected.

A simple majority requires fifty percent of the members present during the last roll call, plus one. For example, if 99 members are present, 51 affirmative votes are required for passage.

3. Introduction to the United Nations Security Council

The United Nations Security Council (UNSC) is one of the six principal organs of the United Nations, established in 1945 following the Second World War. Its primary responsibility is the maintenance of international peace and security. Unlike the General Assembly, which provides a forum for all UN Member States to discuss international issues, the Security Council can adopt binding decisions for its members.

The Council consists of 15 members: five permanent members (P5) and ten non-permanent members elected for two-year terms. The P5 are China, France, Russia, the United Kingdom and the United States. Each permanent member holds veto power, meaning that a negative vote by any one of them can prevent the adoption of a substantive resolution, even if the majority of Council members support it. Procedurally, however, a veto does not apply.

Under Article 27 of the UN Charter, substantive resolutions require at least nine affirmative votes and no veto from a permanent member. This voting structure gives the UNSC considerable authority but can also limit its ability to respond to international crises when major powers disagree.

3.1 What Makes the UNSC Unique?

The Security Council's defining feature is its ability to move beyond discussion and adopt decisions that UN Member States are obligated to carry out. Under Chapter VII of the UN Charter, the Council can determine that a situation constitutes a threat to international peace and security and adopt measures to address it.

These measures range from sanctions and diplomatic restrictions to, where authorised, military action. Sanctions are particularly important because they provide a means of exerting pressure without immediately resorting to armed force. Under

Article 41, the Council may impose non-military measures, including restrictions on economic relations, financial transactions and diplomatic ties.

However, the UNSC does not have its own independent economic enforcement system. Member States are responsible for implementing sanctions through their national laws, financial institutions, customs authorities and other relevant agencies.

Recommended Reading

Delegates are highly encouraged to further understand the powers of the UNSC by reading the United Nations Charter, specifically Chapters V, VI and VII, which outline the key functions of the committee.

4. Understanding Sanctions

Agenda: Maintenance of International Peace and Security: Assessing the Effectiveness, Enforcement and Exit of Sanctions Regimes

Sanctions are restrictive measures imposed to influence the behaviour of a state, organisation, group or individual. Within the UNSC, they are used to address threats to international peace and security without relying immediately on military force.

Sanctions are not necessarily intended as punishment. Their central purpose is to achieve a specific political or security objective, such as ending support for armed groups, preventing the proliferation of nuclear weapons, reducing violence against civilians or encouraging participation in peace negotiations.

For example, if a state is found to be supplying weapons to an armed group that threatens regional stability, the UNSC may restrict the transfer of weapons to that group or freeze the assets of individuals financing it. The intention is to reduce the group's ability to continue its activities and encourage compliance with international obligations.

Sanctions are therefore best understood as a policy instrument rather than an objective in themselves. Their value depends on whether they contribute to a measurable improvement in peace and security.

4.1 The Legal Basis for Sanctions

The main legal basis for UNSC sanctions is outlined in Chapter VII, particularly Articles 39 and 41, of the UN Charter.

Article	What it does
Article 39	Allows the Council to determine whether a threat to the peace, breach of the peace or act of aggression exists.
Article 41	Authorises measures that do not involve the use of armed force, including economic restrictions and the severance of diplomatic relations.
Article 42	Provides for military action if the Council considers non-military measures inadequate or unsuccessful.

These provisions establish a framework in which sanctions can serve as an intermediate measure between diplomatic efforts and the possible authorisation of military force. They do not, however, require the Council to follow a rigid sequence in every situation.

Once the UNSC adopts a binding sanctions resolution, Member States are expected to implement the measures specified in it.

4.2 How Do Sanctions Work?

Sanctions seek to influence behaviour through several mechanisms. Understanding these mechanisms helps delegates assess not only what a sanction restricts, but also why it might succeed or fail.

- **Coercion (encouraging a behaviour change):** Sanctions impose costs on a target in an attempt to persuade it to change a policy or comply with a demand. For example, restrictions on a government's access to international finance may be intended to encourage it to enter peace negotiations.
- **Constraint (limiting the ability to act):** Sanctions can restrict a target's access to resources, money, equipment, or international networks. An arms embargo, for instance, aims to limit the supply of weapons to a designated group, regardless of whether that group agrees to change its behaviour.

- **Signalling (communicating international disapproval):** Sanctions demonstrate that the international community considers certain conduct unacceptable. They can reinforce international norms, isolate those responsible, and communicate support for victims or states affected by aggression.
- **Deterrence:** Sanctions may discourage a target from taking a prohibited action because it anticipates future costs and repercussions. For example, communicating the consequences of supporting an armed group may discourage other actors and nations from assisting them.

These mechanisms can operate together. An asset freeze might constrain a person's access to money, signal international condemnation, and attempt to coerce a change in conduct. However, restricting resources does not automatically produce political compliance. The target may adapt, seek alternative sources of support, or accept the costs rather than change its policies.

5. Types of Sanctions

Sanctions can be classified according to the pathway through which pressure is applied, the entity being targeted, and the purpose for which the measures are imposed. These categories overlap: a single sanctions regime can include several types of measures, target different actors and pursue multiple objectives.

5.1 Classification by Pathway

Some simple classifications of the types of sanctions include:

- Economic and Trade Sanctions
- Financial Sanctions and Asset Freezes
- Travel Bans
- Arms Embargoes and Commodity Restrictions
- Diplomatic Restrictions

5.2 Classification by the Entity Being Targeted

Comprehensive sanctions restrict a broad range of economic activity involving a country or territory. Such measures can create significant pressure but may also

affect ordinary citizens, businesses and essential services. The UNSC's experience with broad economic restrictions, particularly during the 1990s, contributed to a shift towards more targeted sanctions.

Targeted or smart sanctions focus on particular individuals, organisations, companies, sectors or activities rather than restricting an entire economy. Their purpose is to place pressure on those considered responsible for threatening peace and security while limiting unintended harm to the wider population.

Targeted sanctions can include:

- Individuals, such as political or military leaders.
- Non-state armed groups and terrorist organisations.
- Companies, financial networks or entities supporting prohibited activities.
- Specific sectors, goods or activities connected to a threat to international peace and security.

The distinction is important because sanctions aimed at a small group of decision-makers may create a different pattern of pressure from measures affecting an entire economy. Nevertheless, targeted sanctions are not automatically harmless. Restrictions can still affect employees, suppliers, families, and the broader economy.

5.3 Classification by Purpose: What Are Sanctions Intended to Achieve?

Purpose	Explanation
Coercion	Persuading a target to reverse or change a particular policy.
Deterrence	Discouraging future violations by establishing credible consequences.
Constraint	Limiting a target's ability to obtain resources or continue prohibited activities.
Signalling	Demonstrating international disapproval and reinforcing international norms.
Conflict management	Supporting ceasefires, peace negotiations or political settlements.
Non-proliferation	Restricting access to resources, technology or materials used in developing nuclear or other prohibited weapons capabilities.
Counter-terrorism	Disrupting terrorist financing, travel and access to resources.
Protection of civilians	Pressuring those responsible for serious abuses or obstruction of humanitarian assistance.

These purposes are not mutually exclusive. A sanctions regime intended to constrain an armed group may also signal international disapproval and support a peace process. The Council must define the intended outcome clearly enough to assess whether the measures are working.

6. Strategic Design of Sanctions

The design of a sanctions regime refers to the decisions made before and during its adoption about whom to target, which restrictions to impose, what outcomes to seek and how success will be evaluated.

Poorly designed sanctions can impose high costs without changing the behaviour that originally prompted them. Effective design therefore requires the UNSC to

consider the circumstances of each situation rather than applying the same measures to every conflict.

6.1 Defining Clear Objectives

Every sanctions regime should have a clearly defined objective. A resolution demanding that a state stop supporting an armed group, for example, should specify the conduct that must change. Vague demands make it difficult for the target to understand what compliance requires and for the Council to assess whether sanctions have achieved their purpose.

Objectives should be realistic, measurable and connected to the threat being addressed. Delegates should consider whether the objective requires an immediate action, such as ending a particular weapons transfer, or a longer-term political change, such as participation in a peace agreement.

6.2 Selecting the Appropriate Targets

The Council must identify the actors responsible for the conduct it seeks to change. Targeting those directly involved may create pressure while reducing the broader economic consequences of sanctions.

However, determining responsibility can be difficult, particularly when armed groups operate through informal financial networks or companies conceal their links to prohibited activities. The Council must balance the need for reliable evidence against the need to respond promptly to threats.

6.3 Proportionality and Humanitarian Safeguards

Proportionality, in this context, means considering whether the likely benefits of a measure justify its foreseeable costs and whether a less harmful measure could achieve the same objective.

Broad restrictions on trade or finance may affect access to food, medicine, employment and essential services, even when these are not the intended targets. Targeted measures can also have indirect humanitarian consequences if banks, businesses or suppliers avoid otherwise permitted transactions because they fear penalties for violating sanctions.

Humanitarian exemptions, clear guidance and reliable procedures for approving permitted transactions can help reduce these consequences. Delegates should

consider how the UNSC can maintain pressure on those responsible for threats to peace without unnecessarily harming civilians.

6.4 Coordination with Other Measures

Sanctions rarely operate most effectively in isolation. They may be combined with mediation, diplomacy, peacekeeping, peacebuilding and negotiations. A sanctions regime can create incentives for a party to negotiate, while diplomatic engagement provides a route through which that party can demonstrate compliance.

The UNSC should therefore consider how sanctions fit within a broader strategy for resolving the underlying conflict. Restrictions without a credible diplomatic pathway may create pressure without providing a practical means of reaching a settlement.

7. Implementation and Enforcement

Adopting a sanctions resolution is only the first step. Implementation determines whether the measures produce real-world effects.

The UNSC establishes sanctions committees to oversee particular regimes. These committees, made up of the Council's 15 members, monitor implementation, consider relevant information and carry out responsibilities established by the applicable resolutions. Expert panels or monitoring groups may investigate violations, examine supply networks and report on the effects of sanctions.

Individual Member States must then translate the relevant decisions into action. This may involve freezing designated assets, restricting prohibited exports, screening financial transactions, monitoring borders and investigating suspected violations.

7.1 Key Challenges in Implementation

- **Uneven enforcement:** States have different financial systems, legal frameworks, administrative resources, and capacities to monitor compliance. These differences can create gaps in enforcement.
- **Evasion and illicit networks:** Targets may use intermediaries, front companies, concealed ownership structures, or alternative trade routes to avoid restrictions.
- **Limited cooperation:** Governments may be unwilling to enforce measures that conflict with their economic interests or political relationships.

- **Unclear requirements:** Complex rules or inadequate guidance can lead banks, businesses, and government agencies to interpret sanctions inconsistently.
- **Humanitarian access:** Financial institutions and suppliers may withdraw from permitted activities because they are uncertain about exemptions or concerned about legal consequences.
- **Accountability and due process:** Individuals and organisations must have access to clear procedures for challenging their designation, correcting errors and seeking removal from sanctions lists where appropriate.

These challenges demonstrate that the effectiveness of sanctions depends not only on the strength of the resolution but also on the quality of enforcement, international cooperation and safeguards.

8. The Effectiveness of Sanctions

One of the central questions facing the UNSC is whether sanctions actually achieve their intended objectives. The answer is complicated because effectiveness cannot be measured solely by whether the target experiences economic hardship.

A sanctions regime may impose substantial costs but fail to change the target's behaviour. Alternatively, it may not achieve immediate compliance but still restrict an armed group's access to weapons, disrupt financing, or support diplomatic negotiations.

8.1 How Can Effectiveness Be Measured?

The UNSC should evaluate sanctions against the objective for which they were imposed. Several indicators can help establish whether the measures are working.

Indicator	What it measures
Behavioural change	Whether the target has changed the specific conduct identified in the resolution.
Constraint	Whether the target's access to weapons, funds, equipment or other resources has decreased.
Deterrence	Whether the threat of sanctions discourages further violations or similar conduct by other actors.
Diplomatic progress	Whether sanctions contribute to ceasefires, negotiations or political agreements.
Implementation	Whether Member States are enforcing the restrictions and whether evasion is decreasing.
Humanitarian impact	Whether sanctions are causing unintended harm to civilians or obstructing essential services.
Cost-effectiveness	Whether the outcomes justify the economic, political and administrative costs of the measures.

Evaluations should also consider what might have happened without sanctions. For example, a reduction in weapons transfers may reflect sanctions, diplomatic negotiations, changes in the conflict or several factors operating together. Establishing causation is therefore difficult.

8.2 What Does the Research Show?

A major research project published in 2013, *Targeted Sanctions*, edited by Thomas J. Biersteker, Sue E. Eckert and Marcos Tourinho, examined the effectiveness of UN targeted sanctions imposed since 1991. Its findings, summarised in a UN sanctions fact sheet, illustrate why effectiveness must be evaluated across multiple objectives:

Share of Cases Assessed as Successful

- **10%** in **coercing behavioural change** (persuading the target to change its behaviour).
- **28%** in **constraining negative behaviour** (limiting the target's ability to carry out harmful activities).
- **27%** in **signalling international norms** (reinforcing international expectations and norms).

Source: UN Security Council sanctions fact sheet, drawing on Biersteker, Eckert and Tourinho's 2013 research.

The findings suggest that sanctions may be more useful for restricting a target's capabilities or signalling international disapproval than for compelling an immediate change in policy. They also challenge the assumption that sanctions should be judged only by whether a target fully complies with the Council's demands.

These figures should be interpreted with care. They reflect a particular research project and its definitions of success, not the success rate of every sanctions regime today. Different objectives, methods and time periods can produce different findings.

More broadly, research published in *Annual Review of Political Science* in 2024 finds that economic sanctions can exert more influence than some earlier assessments suggested, while also highlighting substantial indirect and humanitarian costs. The research emphasises the importance of measuring both intended outcomes and unintended consequences.

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10. Questions a Resolution Must Answer (QARMA)

1. Under what circumstances should the UNSC impose sanctions rather than rely primarily on diplomacy, mediation or other measures?

2. How can the Council ensure that each sanctions regime has clear, realistic and measurable objectives linked to the threat to international peace and security?
3. What standards of evidence and designation criteria should be used to identify individuals, organisations, companies or states responsible for threatening international peace and security?
4. How should the Council determine whether financial restrictions, travel bans, arms embargoes, trade restrictions or a combination of measures would be most appropriate for a particular situation?
5. What safeguards should prevent sanctions from imposing unnecessary economic or humanitarian costs on civilians and populations not responsible for the targeted conduct?
6. What mechanisms can improve cooperation between Member States and ensure that sanctions are implemented consistently across different national jurisdictions?
7. What measures can the Council introduce to improve monitoring, information-sharing and accountability when targets attempt to circumvent sanctions?
8. What procedures should ensure that food, medicine, humanitarian assistance and other permitted activities remain accessible without undermining the objectives of sanctions?
9. Which indicators should the Council use to assess behavioural change, the restriction of prohibited activities, progress in negotiations and unintended consequences?
10. Should sanctions regimes include mandatory review periods, independent assessments or clearly defined benchmarks for evaluating their continued necessity and effectiveness?
11. What evidence of compliance or change in circumstances should be required before the Council relaxes, modifies or suspends sanctions?
12. How can the Council establish credible termination criteria that prevent sanctions from continuing unnecessarily while ensuring that the original threat has been adequately addressed?
13. How should the Council respond when sanctions fail to achieve their objectives despite prolonged implementation?

14. What approaches can help maintain collective action and consistent enforcement when UNSC members disagree over the objectives, scope, or continuation of sanctions?
15. How should sanctions be coordinated with diplomacy, mediation, peacebuilding, and other measures to ensure that they contribute to a sustainable political settlement?